So far, we have been looking at the surface representation or the linguistic features of the content of the question to decide which questions are insincere. It is also possible to combine additional metadata such as the topic of the question and the profile of the users who posted the question — whether they have a history of posing such 'insincere questions' in the past, and their network connections. I leave it to our readers to try these possibilities as a solution for the Kaggle competition on 'insincere questions'.

So far, we have not considered the possible answers to such 'insincere questions' as a potential input in our classification schemes. Let us assume that we have answers for the questions for both sincere and insincere questions. How can we use the answers to provide additional contextual information to our classifier models? Given that information-seeking questions are typically factual in nature, it is logical to hypothesise that the answers to a factual question should be factual. Similarly, since rhetorical questions are subjective, their answers should also contain opinions. Hence, we can use the answers to augment the question text and pass the combined passage as input to a subjectivity classifier. Alternatively, we can use two different subjectivity classifiers – one for the question and another for the answer, and combine the results of both to predict the final result.

Our readers may be wondering at this point how we can get the answers to the Quora insincere question data set since the answers are not published. One possibility is to retrieve the results from a search engine and use the top ranked answer snippet as the answer. We will discuss more on this in next month's column.

If you have any favourite programming questions/ software topics that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at *sandyasm_AT_yahoo_DOT_com*. Wishing all our readers happy coding until next month! END

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In the above command, the *+i* flag sets the immutable attribute to a given file. Let us try to delete this file with root privileges:

```
$ sudo rm immutable.txt
rm: cannot remove 'immutable.txt': Operation not permitted
```

The result is as expected. We cannot remove this file unless we remove the immutable attribute. Let us try to delete it by removing the immutable attribute:

```
$ sudo chattr -i immutable.txt
$ rm immutable.txt
```

Converting the DOS file format to UNIX: Users often develop scripts on one machine and copy it over to multiple machines for testing/production purposes. If a script is stored in the DOS file format, then it adds the addition control-M (^M) character as a line ending character, which makes the script unusable on GNU/Linux. To make it usable on GNU/Linux, we have to convert its file format to UNIX. We can easily do this using the *dos2unix* command.

Let us take a file in the DOS format, as shown below:

```
$ file output.txt
output.txt: ASCII text, with CRLF, LF line terminator
```

Now convert it to UNIX and verify its file format:

```
$ dos2unix output.txt
$ file output.txt
output.txt: ASCII text
```

Flush caches: GNU/Linux uses RAM as a caching mechanism to improve system performance. This cache is flushed periodically. However, we can flush the cache explicitly at any time. We can either flush it using *Page cache* and *inode cache*, or both. Let us look at this with an example.

To drop *Page cache*, execute the following command as a root user:

```
# sync && echo 1 > /proc/sys/vm/drop_caches
```

To drop *inode and dentry cache*, execute the following command as a root user:

```
# sync && echo 2 > /proc/sys/vm/drop_caches
```

To drop both caches, execute the following command as a root user:

```
# sync && echo 3 > /proc/sys/vm/drop_caches
```

END

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